

GERIATRIC DEPRESSION SCALE (GDS-15)

Screening Tool for Depression in Older Adults (Short Form)

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

Patient Name: _____

Age / DOB: ____/____/____

MRN / ID: _____

Unit / Ward / Bed: _____

Surgery / Diagnosis: _____

Date / Time: ____/____/____ : ____

QUESTIONS 1 TO 8

Parameter / Criterion	Options & Points
1. Basically satisfied with life?	☐ Yes (0) ☐ No (1)
2. Dropped many activities/interests?	☐ No (0) ☐ Yes (1)
3. Feel that your life is empty?	☐ No (0) ☐ Yes (1)
4. Often get bored?	☐ No (0) ☐ Yes (1)
5. In good spirits most of the time?	☐ Yes (0) ☐ No (1)
6. Afraid something bad will happen?	☐ No (0) ☐ Yes (1)
7. Feel happy most of the time?	☐ Yes (0) ☐ No (1)
8. Often feel helpless?	☐ No (0) ☐ Yes (1)

Administration Guide: Ask patient how they felt over the past week. Questions are answered Yes or No. Bolded/underlined answers indicate depressive symptomatology (1 point each). Scores ≥ 5 warrant comprehensive clinical evaluation.

QUESTIONS 9 TO 15

Parameter / Criterion	Options & Points
9. Prefer to stay home rather than go out?	☐ No (0) ☐ Yes (1)
10. More problems with memory than most?	☐ No (0) ☐ Yes (1)
11. Wonderful to be alive now?	☐ Yes (0) ☐ No (1)
12. Feel pretty worthless the way you are?	☐ No (0) ☐ Yes (1)
13. Feel full of energy?	☐ Yes (0) ☐ No (1)
14. Feel your situation is hopeless?	☐ No (0) ☐ Yes (1)
15. Think most people are better off than you?	☐ No (0) ☐ Yes (1)

TOTAL SCORE: [] POINTS (Maximum: 15 points)**Assessor (RN / License #):** _____**CLINICAL INTERPRETATION & RECOMMENDED NURSING ACTIONS****Normal / No Depression (0 - 4 points)**

Depressive symptoms unlikely. Routine healthy aging surveillance.

Suggestive of Mild Depression (5 - 9 points)

Evaluation by primary care physician, explore social engagement.

Suggestive of Severe Depression (10 - 15 points)

High likelihood of major depression. Comprehensive geriatric psychiatry evaluation.

Registered Nurse (RN) Signature & Professional Stamp

Date & Time of Assessment